



Stearman Model 75



B-17 Flying Fortress



747-400



787 Dreamliner

- 1881** William E. Boeing is born.
1917 The Boeing Airplane Company is incorporated.
1927 Boeing Model 40As are given a contract for an airmail service between Chicago and San Francisco.
1930 The Monomail, an advanced all-metal mailplane, enters service.
1932 Boeing reveals the P-26 "Peashooter." This was the first all-metal American fighter and the first monoplane to be operated by the USAAC.

- 1933** The first truly modern airliner, the Boeing 247, flies.
1934 The Stearman Model 75 is introduced and used as a training plane. Boeing Airplane splits from United Airlines and William Boeing resigns.
1935 The World War II bomber, the B-17, flies.
1938 Boeing introduces the first commercial aircraft with a pressurized cabin, the Model 307 Stratoliner.
1945 B-29 Super Fortresses drop atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

- 1947** The B-47 Stratojet is launched.
1952 The legendary B-52 Stratofortress flies for the first time.
1954 The prototype Model 367-80 flies out.
1955 Test pilot "Tex" Johnston barrel-rolls the Dash 80 over Lake Washington during the Seattle Seafair.
1961 Vertol, Boeing's helicopter division, introduces the CH-47. Known as the Chinook, it remains in production.
1968 The 737, the most successful jetliner ever made, enters service.

- 1969** The prototype 747 enters flight-test. The first of the "wide-bodies," this iconic aircraft transforms global air travel.
1981 The 767, Boeing's first new jetliner for over a decade, makes its maiden flight. The narrow-body 757 enters service.
1983 Boeing merges with McDonnell Douglas.
1997 The company's corporate headquarters moves from Seattle to Chicago.
2001 The 737 MAX is grounded after two fatal accidents, but flies again in 2021.

B-17 "Flying Fortress" and B-29 "Superfortress" bombers. After the war, a number of orders were canceled and the workforce at Boeing shrank by 70,000 people. The company promptly produced the Stratocruiser (which was developed from the B-29), but this did not sell particularly well to the airlines. The USAF bought

some as C-97 transports, but the introduction of jet fighters meant that the air force needed an aerial refueling capability. Boeing designed a system to meet this need, incorporated it into a C-97, called it the KC-97 tanker and the USAF bought 816 of them. Other notable military aircraft built by Boeing at this time include the B-47 Stratojet and B-52 Stratofortress bombers. Around 80 B-52H Stratofortresses remain in service today.

The KC-97 was superseded by a new jet-propelled tanker that could be used as a military transport or commercial airliner. The Model 367-80, known as the Dash 80, featured a number of innovations for an airliner, including a wing swept to 35 degrees, engines in pods slung under the wings, two sets of ailerons, spoilers, and reverse thrust. This would become the model for the 707.

Although not the first jetliner, the 707 proved to be the most successful first-generation aircraft ever, with 1,010 sold. Buoyed by the success of the 707 and the KC-135 Stratotanker, the company launched the 727 trijet in 1960 and the twin-engine 737 in 1967. The 727 also sold well, with 1,832 produced, while the 737 is still in production and is the most successful jetliner ever, with more than 7,370 having been built. In 1969, Boeing debuted the jetliner that would transform global travel, the iconic 747. More than twice as big as a 707, its development was a giant leap of faith for Boeing, and President William Bill Allen literally "bet the



Boeing Dreamliner engine

The General Electric GENx (General Electric Next-generation) is one of two engines in production for Boeing's 787.

company" that it would be a success. The first of the wide-body jets, the 747 was nicknamed the "Jumbo Jet" and the world's airlines queued up to buy it. Other successful designs include the 757, 767, and the 777. The latest—the 787 Dreamliner—is the world's largest composite aircraft.

Boeing's dominance has allowed it to acquire many of its competitors. However, the company's reputation was tarnished by the corners cut in "self-certifying" 737 MAX flight control software, which led to the infamous accidents of 2018–2019.

Blended wing design

In cooperation with Boeing, NASA is testing the design of an experimental blended-wing aircraft, the X-48B, under its Fundamental Aeronautics research program. A blended-wing airliner could achieve fuel savings of over 20%.

